

Japan • Tokyo → Hakone → Kyoto → Osaka

October 9–23, 2026 • 15 days • 14 nights • open-jaw into Tokyo, out of Kansai / KIX

5 nights Tokyo

Edition Ginza • Oct 9–14

2 nights Hakone

Gora KARAKU • Oct 14–16

4 nights Kyoto

Machiya Fukune • Oct 16–20

3 nights Osaka

InterContinental Umeda • Oct 20–23

14 nights



Ginza 5 • Hakone 2 • Kyoto 4 • Osaka 3



Confirmed hotel spine • leave each city on check-in morning of the next stay

Activity colors

- | | |
|----------------------------------|----------------------------|
| ● Dining / food | ● Museums / culture / show |
| ● Parks / walking / scenery | ● Trains / transit days |
| ● Shopping (stationery, kitchen) | ● Baseball / sports |
| ● Hotels / rest / onsen | ● Festivals |

Day cards use matching pills. Walking lists use the same colors as mini-tags.

Hotels are confirmed. Prefer Haneda arrival over Narita if the fare is close. Book an afternoon or evening KIX flight on Oct 23 — not morning — because Oct 22 is a long Kyoto festival day trip with a late return to Osaka.

Oct 22 festivals from Osaka: Base is InterContinental Osaka (Umeda) for Oct 20–23, so Jidai Matsuri + Kurama Fire Festival are a Kyoto day trip. Doable if energy allows: morning train to Kyoto, procession midday, Eizan up to Kurama for the fires, late return to Umeda. Alternate: skip Kurama and keep a lighter day. Prefer the full festival day if legs hold.

Confirmed hotels

STAY	NIGHTS	CHECK-IN → OUT
The Tokyo EDITION, Ginza	5	Fri Oct 9 → Wed Oct 14
Hakone Gora KARAKU	2	Wed Oct 14 → Fri Oct 16
Kyoto Machiya Fukune	4	Fri Oct 16 → Tue Oct 20
InterContinental Hotel Osaka (Grand Front / Umeda)	3	Tue Oct 20 → Fri Oct 23 → KIX

Walking radius by hotel

Things matching shared interests within roughly 5–20 minutes on foot (Hakone: walk / hotel shuttle / short cable-car hops around Gora).

The Tokyo EDITION, Ginza • 5 nights

2-8-13 Ginza, Chuo-ku, Tokyo 104-0061 • Chuo-dori / Higashi-Ginza corridor

- Kabuki-za — about 5–8 min walk; book one act while based here
- Itoya Ginza — stationery flagship (two buildings), ~5–10 min
- Ginza sushi counters + Tsukiji outer market (~15–20 min) for lunch bowls
- Depachika pastry: Mitsukoshi / Matsuya / Ginza Six food halls — short walks
- Hibiya Park or Imperial Palace outer gardens — ~15–20 min west
- Back streets between Ginza and Higashi-Ginza (off Chuo-dori) for quieter loops
- Sports bars in Ginza / Yurakucho for Dodgers mornings; stadiums need a train
- Ginza / Higashi-Ginza subway → Shinjuku for Odakyu Romancecar on Oct 14

Hakone Gora KARAKU • 2 nights

1300-8 Gora, Hakone-machi, Ashigarashimo-gun, Kanagawa 250-0408 • free shuttle ~3–5 min from Gora Station (hilly)

- Private open-air bath in-room + rooftop / reservable baths on property — the stay's centerpiece
- Hakone Gora Park — roughly 10 min walk / short hop from Gora Station
- Hakone Open-Air Museum — one stop toward Chokoku-no-Mori / short walk
- Gora Station: Hakone Tozan Railway + cable car toward Sounzan → ropeway / Lake Ashi loop
- Lean on ryokan dinner/breakfast; one cafe lunch near Gora if you leave the property
- Not dense city walking — plan ropeway / lake / pirate ship as the “day out,” onsen as the evening

Kyoto Machiya Fukune • 4 nights

105-3 Nishirokkakucho, Nakagyo-ku, Kyoto 604-8217 • central Nakagyo near Horikawa / Rokkaku

- Nishiki Market — ~10 min; snacks, knives at Aritsugu
- Pontocho / Kiyamachi alleys — ~10–15 min for evening grazing
- Kyoto International Manga Museum / Karasuma corridor — short walk or one subway stop
- Stationery and kitchen tools around Nishiki / Teramachi covered streets
- Kyoto Imperial Palace gardens — ~15–20 min north on foot or quick bus/subway
- Neighborhood cafes for reading; bakery breakfasts before Arashiyama / Fushimi days
- Easy subway / bus to Kyoto Station (Sagano, Shinkansen corridor) and Keihan for Fushimi

InterContinental Hotel Osaka • 3 nights

3-60 Ofuka-cho, Kita-ku, Osaka 530-0011 • Grand Front Osaka North Building Tower C • Umeda (not Temmabashi / castle)

- ~5 min walk to JR Osaka / Umeda / Hankyu — perfect for Kyoto day trips and Haruka via Shin-Osaka
- Grand Front + Umeda depachika / izakaya density — okonomiyaki, kushikatsu, ramen without a long hop
- Light Dotonbori is a short subway ride; prefer neighborhood Umeda food most nights
- Umeda Sky Building / floating garden (~10–15 min) for a view; Kita back streets off the malls
- Hankyu / Hanshin / Grand Front for pastry, kitchen gadgets, stationery browsing
- Umeda sports bars for MLB mornings; live NPB is elsewhere if schedules align
- Limousine bus stops near Umeda / Hankyu, or JR Haruka from Shin-Osaka (~10 min local from Osaka Sta.)

Money & trains

- **Cash:** Pull yen at a **7-Eleven ATM** with a US debit card (most reliable for American cards).
- **Translate:** Google Translate camera mode before you land.
- **Walk more than the app suggests.** Neighborhood streets between stations are often the point.
- **Ratings:** Tabelog over Google; a 3.5 there can still be excellent.
- **Konbini:** Onigiri, ATM, tickets. Carry trash — public bins are scarce.
- **Tickets:** Suica/Pasmo for cities. Odakyu Romancecar Shinjuku → Hakone-Yumoto Oct 14. Shinkansen Odawara → Kyoto Oct 16 via SmartEX. Kyoto ↔ Osaka ordinary JR/Hankyu/Keihan. KIX Oct 23: Haruka from Shin-Osaka or limousine bus from Umeda.
- **Luggage:** Forward Tokyo → Kyoto (or Osaka) with Yamato while overnighing Hakone with a small bag — or take bags on the Romancecar. Forward to KIX before departure if helpful.

Hakone notes

- Luxury ryokan-style stay in Gora — midweek Oct 14–16 is a good window.
- Romancecar Shinjuku → Hakone-Yumoto, then Tozan Railway to Gora + hotel shuttle.
- Hakone Free Pass (Odakyu) or Romancecar reserved seat + local pay-as-you-go.
- **Onsen etiquette:** Wash at the stools before entering; no swimsuits in traditional baths; hair up / towel off the water; quiet voices. Tattoos: confirm with KARAKU — in-room open-air baths solve most issues.

From a friend's notes

Curated for museums, parks, cafes, pastry, stationery, kitchen tools, scenic trains, kabuki, sushi/ramen, graffiti, off-path walks, and baseball.

- **Tokyo add-ons:** Sangenjaya alleys, Jimbocho books/udon, Kichijoji or Monzen-Nakacho for craft / standing sake.
- **Reinforced:** Edition Ginza = Kabuki-za + Itoya on foot. Yanaka with cash. Kappabashi off Asakusa's main drag.
- **Kyoto:** Nakagyo base for Nishiki / Pontocho. Kiyomizu + yatsubashi + Gion wooden streets on a buffer or Oct 21 from Osaka.
- **Osaka:** Neighborhood izakaya over a full Dotonbori marathon; one neon walk is enough.
- **Skip:** Harajuku main drag, TeamLab queues, Golden Pavilion as a must, Hiroshima day trip, Michelin/Jiro chase.

Day by day

FRI OCT 9 · TOKYO · EDITION GINZA

HOTEL

TRANSIT

FOOD

WALK

Arrive, settle, first bowls

Land, 7-Eleven ATM, check in at the Edition. Light Ginza / Tsukiji-outer walk only. Kabuki-za is dark today.

Eat: Ramen for dinner. Onigiri or depachika pastry if late.

Dodgers Game 5 (if any) = Japan morning Oct 10, not tonight.

SAT OCT 10 · TOKYO

WALK

CULTURE

BASEBALL

FOOD

Koenji graffiti + baseball if available

Early Koenji murals, then a street-art walking tour. Night: Climax Series First Stage if a Tokyo/Yokohama venue.

Eat: Koenji lunch. Yakitori after the game.

SUN OCT 11 · TOKYO

PARK

MUSEUM

FOOD

Ueno park, museum, Yanaka cafes

Ueno Park, Tokyo National Museum, then Yanaka / Nezu / Sendagi kissaten.

Eat: Park pastry; sushi dinner in the Ueno–Ginza corridor.

MON OCT 12 · TOKYO · HOLIDAY

TRAIN

SCENERY

DODGERS

FOOD

Enoden Kamakura — or Ginza / parks

Enoden coastal streetcar, Great Buddha, Hase cafes — or stay soft near the hotel (Hibiya / palace gardens).

Eat: Kamakura pastry/seafood or Ginza depachika.

NLCS Game 1 morning if Dodgers advance — sports-bar breakfast near Ginza/Yurakucho.

TUE OCT 13 · TOKYO · KABUKI DAY

SHOPPING

SHOW

FOOD

Kappabashi, stationery, Kabuki-za

Kappabashi knives/tools; Kakimori and/or Itoya Ginza. **Prioritize Kabuki-za** while at the Edition (dark Oct 9; program through Oct 20).

Eat: Tempura near Asakusa or Ginza sushi around the show.

Last easy Tokyo baseball window before Hakone — only if energy.

WED OCT 14 · TOKYO → HAKONE · GORA KARAKU

ROMANCECAR

ONSEN

FOOD

Romancecar west, onsen evening

Check out. Odakyu Romancecar Shinjuku → Hakone-Yumoto → Tozan to Gora → KARAKU. Quiet onsen night — skip Tokyo baseball.

Eat: Ryokan dinner if included.

Forward luggage Tokyo → Kyoto/Osaka, or travel with bags.

THU OCT 15 · HAKONE

SCENERY

ROPEWAY

ONSEN

FOOD

Ropeway, lake, or slow onsen day

Classic loop: cable car → ropeway → Lake Ashi pirate ship — or stay soft at the ryokan with a Gora Park / cafe outing.

Eat: Cafe lunch with a view; ryokan dinner.

FRI OCT 16 · HAKONE → KYOTO · MACHIYA FUKUNE

SHINKANSEN

HOTEL

WALK

FOOD

Down the mountain, settle Nakagyo

Hakone-Yumoto → Odawara → Shinkansen to Kyoto. Check in at Machiya Fukune. Short Nishiki / Pontocho evening — no temple marathon.

Eat: Ekiben; Kyoto obanzai or Pontocho grazing.

SAT OCT 17 · KYOTO

SCENIC TRAIN

PARK

FOOD

Arashiyama + Sagano Romantic Train

Arashiyama early, Sagano Romantic Train through the Hozu gorge. Gardens over bamboo photo lines. Optional dusk Fushimi Inari.

Eat: Yudofu / river lunch; Kyoto ramen evening.

SUN OCT 18 · KYOTO

MUSEUM

WALK

SHOPPING

FOOD

Museum, Philosopher's Path, cafe

Kyoto National Museum, Philosopher's Path, Demachiyanagi / Okazaki cafe. Nishiki Arisugu if still wanting a knife.

Eat: Pastry breakfast; soba or sushi dinner.

MON OCT 19 · KYOTO

WALK

FOOD

CULTURE

Fushimi sake alleys

Fushimi brewery canals and tasting rooms — different Fushimi from the shrine gates. Or Kiyomizu–Gion if you’d rather save sake.

Eat: Small plates with sake.

TUE OCT 20 · KYOTO → OSAKA · INTERCONTINENTAL UMEDA

TRANSIT

HOTEL

FOOD

Short hop west, Osaka food night

JR / Hankyu / Keihan to Osaka (~15–45 min). Check in at InterContinental (Grand Front / Umeda). Neighborhood okonomiyaki / izakaya; light Dotonbori only if you want neon once.

Eat: Osaka savory night.

WED OCT 21 · OSAKA BUFFER

PARK

DAY TRIP

FOOD

Parks & cafes — or Nara — or Kyoto Kiyomizu

Soft: Umeda Sky / cafe reading. Day trip: Nara. Kyoto option: Kiyomizu + Gion, return to Umeda for sleep before festival day.

Eat: Bakery crawl or tonkatsu.

THU OCT 22 · OSAKA BASE · KYOTO DAY TRIP

FESTIVAL

TRAIN

SCENERY

FOOD

Jidai Matsuri + Kurama Fire Festival

Recommended: Early Osaka → Kyoto. Jidai Matsuri (~noon–3pm, Palace → Heian Shrine). Evening Eizan to Kurama for the Fire Festival. Late return to InterContinental Umeda.

Lighter: Jidai only, or skip Kurama.

Eat: Early heavy meal before Kurama. No tight dinner reservation.

Do not book a morning KIX flight on the 23rd.

FRI OCT 23 · OSAKA → KIX

AIRPORT

CHECKOUT

FOOD

Haruka or bus to KIX, fly home

Haruka from Shin-Osaka (~50 min) or limousine bus from Umeda. Airport 3 hours before long-haul. Afternoon/evening departure only.

Eat: Station/hotel pastry, or after security.

How to eat

Cap ramen at about four bowls. One proper sushi sit-down in Ginza, then sushi as lunch. Kyoto: kaiseki, tofu, obanzai, pastry. Osaka: savory — okonomiyaki, kushikatsu, izakaya. Use Tabelog as a tie-breaker.

Dodgers US night games = Japan morning (~8–11am). LCS ~Oct 12–20 Japan time if they advance. World Series Game 1 is Oct 23 US night — after you fly.

Where it all lands

WANT	WHEN
Museums / show	Tokyo National Museum (11), Kabuki-za (13), Kyoto National Museum (18)
Parks / scenery	Ueno (11), Kamakura or Ginza parks (12), Hakone loop (15), Arashiyama (17), Philosopher's Path (18)
Scenic trains	Enoden (12), Romancecar (14), Hakone ropeway (15), Sagano (17), Eizan (22)
Stationery / kitchen	Itoya + Kappabashi (13), Nishiki Aritsugu (18)
Baseball	Climax Series Oct 10–13 while in Tokyo
Festivals	Jidai + Kurama day trip from Osaka (22)

Book next

1. **Done — hotels confirmed:** Edition Ginza Oct 9–14 · Gora KARAKU Oct 14–16 · Machiya Fukune Oct 16–20 · InterContinental Osaka (Umeda) Oct 20–23.
2. Open-jaw flights: Haneda (preferred) or Narita Oct 9 → KIX Oct 23 afternoon/evening.
3. Airport transfers; Haruka Shin-Osaka → KIX or Umeda limousine bus Oct 23.
4. Romancecar Shinjuku → Hakone-Yumoto, Wed Oct 14.
5. Shinkansen Odawara → Kyoto, Fri Oct 16 (SmartEX).

6. Yamato luggage forward Tokyo → Kyoto/Osaka around Oct 14; optional → KIX before Oct 23.
 7. Kabuki-za tickets on sale Mon Sep 14 — one act Oct 10–13 at the Edition.
 8. Sagano Romantic Train Sat Oct 17.
 9. Hakone Free Pass or Romancecar + local transit.
 0. Climax Series tickets if Kanto hosts Oct 10–13.
 1. Koenji street-art tour Sat Oct 10 morning.
 2. One Ginza sushi reservation Oct 11 or 13.
 3. Sports bar for MLB mornings.
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Pack

Layers, light jacket, compact umbrella, broken-in shoes, onsen bag for Hakone. Low 70s °F possible at noon; Kurama night on the 22nd is cooler. Keep Oct 21 as energy slack.

Shareable draft · hotels confirmed · recheck events closer to travel · print-friendly colors · NPB / MLB / Kabuki-za calendars online.